

MUJTABA SHAHID

Cybersecurity · Penetration Testing · Secure Software Development

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SUMMARY

Data and Cybersecurity graduate (BSc, University of Doha for Science and Technology) specializing in penetration testing, secure software development, IoT/OT security, and incident response. Hands-on experience across the full offensive and defensive lifecycle, from reconnaissance, exploitation, and privilege escalation to SIEM-based threat hunting, threat modeling, and secure SDLC. Capstone author of a zero-trust proxy architecture that secures multi-agent AI systems built on the Model Context Protocol (MCP). Proven team lead on every group project, with a Grade A in Project Management, and currently pursuing CEH v13 (EC-Council). QID valid and transferable with NOC; available to work in Qatar.

EXPERIENCE

Applications Security and Development Intern

May 2026 - Jul 2026

Uni Eats for Technology and Services W.L.L.

- Independently led the design and development of all three Uni Eats Flutter apps (Customer, Restaurant, Driver), the Admin Dashboard, and the company website end to end, owning UX flows, visual design, brand assets, and the technical build (Firebase: Firestore, Auth, Cloud Functions) with no day-to-day direction, consistently delivering without revision cycles.
- Proactively ran structured QA and blue team/red team security audits against the original production apps across multiple testing rounds on my own initiative, documenting 100+ issues including critical authentication flaws (password reset bypass, insecure token storage) and a Driver App data leak exposing internal database keys and pricing data in report exports.
- Authored 12 internal company policies covering data retention, access control, incident response, acceptable use, vendor onboarding, payment disputes, driver conduct, and system audit logging, cross-referenced against Qatar's PDPL (Law No. 13 of 2016) and the platform's live Firestore rules.
- Identified and drove fixes for systemic platform issues on my own initiative, including rebuilding the order lifecycle state machine and resolving payment race conditions, and presented an AI solutions proposal and cybersecurity architecture plan to the CEO and development team.

Web Developer & Designer (Intern)

May 2025 - Jan 2026

NOVERA.DEV, Doha, Qatar

- Built and launched two Shopify storefronts end-to-end, handling theme customisation, store setup, and mobile responsiveness.
- Shipped responsive frontend work on internal portfolio sites (LIKO, Rivor), focusing on page performance and clean layouts.
- Moved client builds onto WordPress with Elementor and WooCommerce as the agency shifted its stack.
- Picked up the basics of Git workflows, CI/CD, and deployment as part of the agency's DevOps rollout.

Event Operations Coordinator (Freelance)

Nov - Dec 2022

The Planners W.L.L. - FIFA World Cup 2022

- Ran on-site logistics across stadium zones - crowd flow, guest navigation, and entry/exit operations during matchdays.
- Coordinated VIP protocols, media access, and transport routing under live matchday pressure.
- Held the comms line between event control, hospitality, and venue security to keep issues moving in real time.

Customer Service Agent, Airport Services

Oct 2021 - Jan 2022

Qatar Airways

- Handled flight bookings, reschedules, and special-assistance requests on the Amadeus ticketing system.
- Worked boarding gate operations alongside ground ops teams to keep departures on schedule.
- Supported distressed passengers during peak travel hours while staying within IATA and airline service protocols.
- Achieved outstanding customer feedback through effective problem-solving and attentive service.

PROJECTS

Decentralized Zero Trust Proxy for MCP *Capstone Project, UDST*

- Built a zero-trust proxy layer that secures inter-agent communication in multi-agent AI systems using the Model Context Protocol (MCP).
- Addressed prompt injection, agent authentication, and trust verification - drew on research into MCP-Guard, zkMCP, and SAMOS.
- Five-person team under a PhD supervisor; led architecture decisions and wrote the zero-trust chapter of the capstone report.

Stack: Python · FastAPI · Docker · JWT · MCP

Hospital Management System *Secure Software Development Project, UDST*

- Desktop application for patient and staff management with role-based access control and secure data handling.
- Built on OOP design principles, with separation between domain logic, persistence, and UI layers.

Stack: Java · JavaFX · SQLite · IntelliJ IDEA

COURSEWORK HIGHLIGHTS

Penetration Testing

- Executed full-cycle penetration tests in isolated lab environments, covering reconnaissance, exploitation, privilege escalation, lateral movement, and network pivoting.
- Operated industry-standard tooling including Metasploit, MSFvenom, Meterpreter, Burp Suite, Nmap, Wireshark, Nessus, OpenVAS, and Aircrack-ng.
- Analyzed Active Directory attack paths (Pass-the-Hash, Kerberoasting, DCSync) and wireless attacks (WEP/WPA cracking, Evil Twin, deauthentication).

IoT and OT Security

- Assessed and hardened a Flask-based IoT web application on an isolated Raspberry Pi, remediating token leakage, CSRF, plaintext transport, and unauthorized device control.
- Simulated HTTP flood denial-of-service attacks and performed traffic analysis in Wireshark to characterize attack signatures.
- Conducted firmware analysis with Binwalk, with working knowledge of MQTT, BLE, Zigbee, Z-Wave, and SCADA/ICS protocols.

Secure Software Development

- Performed threat modeling with STRIDE, PASTA, and DREAD, applying secure SDLC and DevSecOps practices across project work.
- Implemented cryptographic primitives (AES, RSA, SHA, HMAC, JWT, TLS) and secure API patterns (OAuth 2.0, REST).
- Applied SAST/DAST, input validation, output encoding, and dependency risk management to reduce application attack surface.

Incident Response and Security Monitoring

- Conducted SIEM log analysis and threat hunting in Splunk, including Windows artifact investigation across file paths, SHA-256 hashes, and command-line strings.
- Applied SOC maturity models (CMMI, COBIT), incident response lifecycles (NIST, SANS), and MITRE ATT&CK mapping.
- Worked with cyber threat intelligence frameworks including MISP, STIX/TAXII, YARA, and Sigma rules.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming & Scripting Python, Java, Dart, Bash, PowerShell, SQL, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, YAML

Offensive Security (hands-on) Metasploit, MSFvenom, Burp Suite, Nmap, Wireshark, Tcpdump, Nessus, OpenVAS, Aircrack-ng, Splunk

Offensive Security (familiar) BloodHound, Mimikatz, Impacket, CrackMapExec, Hydra, Hashcat, John the Ripper, SQLmap, Scapy, Snort, Suricata, Empire

IoT / OT Security Raspberry Pi, Binwalk, MQTT; exposure to Arduino, ESP32, HackRF, RTL-SDR, QEMU, Zigbee, Z-Wave

Development & Tooling Git, GitHub, Docker, VS Code, IntelliJ IDEA, Eclipse, VMware, VirtualBox, Jupyter, Packet Tracer

Security Frameworks & Standards MITRE ATT&CK, NIST CSF, OWASP Top 10, SANS, Cyber Kill Chain, Diamond Model, Zero Trust, STRIDE, PASTA, DREAD, ISO 27001

AI-Assisted Development Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini, Perplexity Pro, and open-source LLMs (DeepSeek, GLM, Kimi, MiniMax); agentic coding with Codex, OpenCode, and Claude Code

App & Web Development Flutter, Firebase (Firestore, Auth, Cloud Functions), Firestore Security Rules, REST APIs, Shopify, Node.js, CI/CD, responsive UI/UX design

Platforms & Operating Systems Kali Linux, Ubuntu, Windows Server, Windows 10/11, macOS, Cisco IOS, TryHackMe

CERTIFICATIONS

- **Pre-Security Certificate** - TryHackMe
- **Firewall Essentials** - Palo Alto Networks Academy
- **Cybersecurity Foundation Student Certificate** - Palo Alto Networks
- **Jr. Penetration Tester (PT1)** - TryHackMe (in progress)
- **Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH) v13** - EC-Council (in progress)

EDUCATION

BSc, Data and Cybersecurity | *University of Doha for Science and Technology* Jan 2022 - May 2026

- Part of a five-person research team under a PhD supervisor, working on LLM and agentic AI security.
- Grade A in Project Management; led all group projects across the programme and carried them to top marks.

High School Diploma | *Ideal Indian School, Doha, Qatar* Graduated Mar 2018

LEADERSHIP AND COMMUNICATION

- Group lead on every team-based university project; consistent top grades across group-based assessments.
- Comfortable writing technical reports and capstone-grade documentation in APA-7.
- Spent time on the ground at FIFA World Cup 2022 and at Qatar Airways - used to making calls under real pressure.
- Work in English; also fluent in Urdu, Hindi, and conversational Arabic.